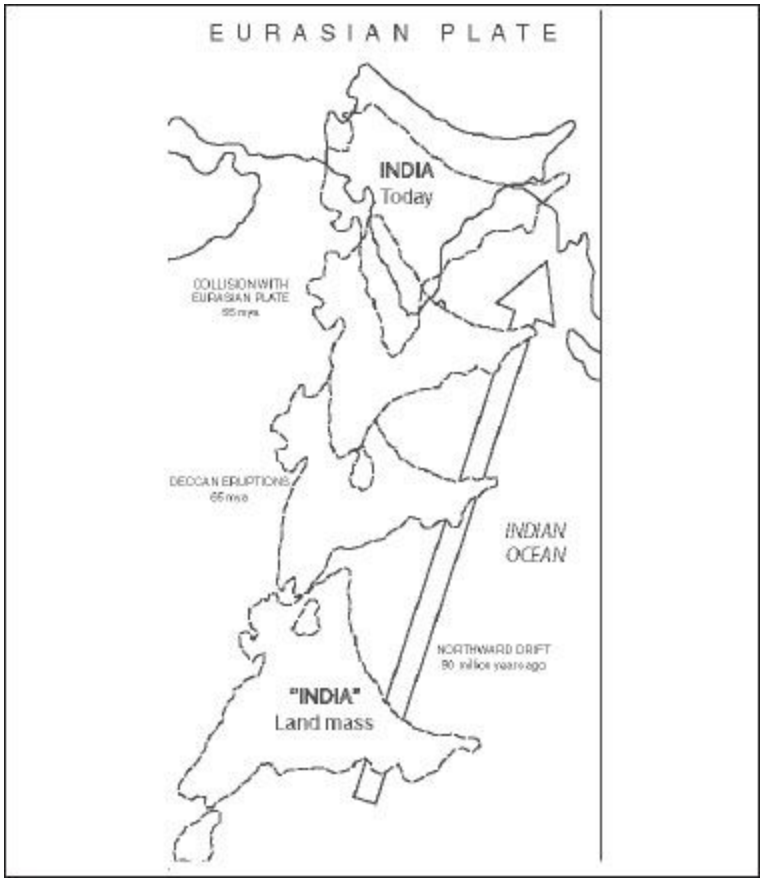
geological impact of this process. Not surprisingly, the resulting tectonic pressures make the Himalayas seismically unstable and prone to frequent and powerful earthquakes.



The northward drift of the Indian land mass

The broad contours of the above narrative of India's geological history are generally accepted. However, there remain many unresolved issues and several findings that do not neatly fit into the story. One puzzle relates to the discovery of a large number of insects preserved in amber found in Vastan, 30 km north of Surat, a geological zone called Cambay Shale. It is a big finding that includes 700 species, representing 55 families. These insects are not unique to India, but very similar to those found in other continents and as far away as Spain. The problem is that the currently accepted view about the northward drift of the Indian craton would mean that the subcontinent would have been an isolated island for tens of millions